

POTATO AND CRÈME FRAÎCHE-FILLED RAVIOLI WITH GARLIC AND ROSEMARY

SERVES
6-8

TOTAL TIME
2 h 30 plus the dough rest

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Egg dough
228 g	Yukon gold potatoes
154 g	Ricotta
225 g	Crème fraîche
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated, for the filling
1/4 lemon	Lemon peel, pith removed and finely chopped
224 g	Olive oil, for frying the garlic
50 g	Garlic, sliced 1/16 inch thick on a mandoline, for the crispy garlic
28 g	Olive oil, for the sauce
10 g	Garlic, thinly sliced
60 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
30 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated, to finish
2 sprigs	Rosemary, leaves picked
quantity not given	Salt

METHOD

- Put the potatoes in a pot, cover them with cold water and bring them to a simmer over medium heat. Give them 30 to 45 minutes, until a fork goes through without resistance.
- Lift them out with a slotted spoon onto a sheet pan and leave them 15 minutes. They dry out a little as they cool.
- Peel them while they are still warm enough to handle, then pass them through a ricer or food mill into a bowl.
- Push the riced potato through a tamis or a fine-mesh strainer a second time so it is perfectly smooth.
- Pulse the ricotta in a food processor to the texture of cake frosting, stopping the moment it turns glossy. Going further breaks it. Scrape it into a bowl.
- When the potato is completely cold, fold in the ricotta, the crème fraîche, the parmigiano and the lemon peel, just enough to combine. Any more working and the potato turns gummy. Salt to taste and refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.
- Line a plate with paper towels. For the crispy garlic, pour the 224 g of oil into a saute pan over low heat, slide the garlic in and cook 3 to 5 minutes, stirring now and then, until the slices take color and firm up. They curl and cluster as they go, so keep moving them or they color unevenly.
- Scoop the garlic out with a slotted spoon and spread it in one layer on the paper to drain. Slices that are still soft will crisp as they dry.
- Make 80 to 100 ravioli with the egg dough and the filling.
- Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil over high heat.
- Slide the ravioli in and pull the heat back so the water only simmers. A rolling boil splits this filling. Cook 2 to 3 minutes. Test the thickest closure, which should give tenderly.
- While they cook, set a large saute pan over low heat with the 28 g of oil. Add the sliced garlic and give it 10 to 15 seconds, until it smells but takes no color.
- Add the butter and three ladles of pasta water, 170 g, then swirl the pan to emulsify.
- Lift the ravioli across with a spider, raise the heat to medium and swirl 30 to 45 seconds, turning them with a spoon so both faces are coated. A splash more pasta water loosens the sauce if it tightens. It is ready when it clings with a gloss.
- Move them to a platter or divide onto plates, spoon the sauce left in the pan over the top and finish with the parmigiano, the rosemary and the crispy garlic.

NOTES

These simmer, they never boil. The potato filling is loose and the seams give way over high heat. Pass the potato twice, through the ricer and then the tamis, and fold the dairy in only until it comes together. Overworked potato goes gummy.

Whip the ricotta only to a frosting-like sheen. Past that point it breaks.

The garlic chips keep crisping while they drain, so pull them while they are just gold and slightly hardened rather than fully brittle.

The 224 g of oil the garlic fries in is not the sauce oil. The sauce takes its own 28 g.

FILLING

Potato and Crème Fraîche Filling

INGREDIENTS

228 g	Yukon gold potatoes
154 g	Ricotta
225 g	Crème fraîche
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
1/4 lemon	Lemon peel, pith removed and finely chopped
quantity not given	Salt

METHOD

1. Put the potatoes in a pot, cover them with cold water and bring them to a simmer over medium heat. Give them 30 to 45 minutes, until a fork goes through without resistance.
2. Lift them out with a slotted spoon onto a sheet pan and leave them 15 minutes. They dry out a little as they cool.
3. Peel them while they are still warm enough to handle, then pass them through a ricer or food mill into a bowl.
4. Push the riced potato through a tamis or a fine-mesh strainer a second time so it is perfectly smooth.
5. Pulse the ricotta in a food processor to the texture of cake frosting, stopping the moment it turns glossy. Going further breaks it. Scrape it into a bowl.
6. When the potato is completely cold, fold in the ricotta, the crème fraîche, the parmigiano and the lemon peel, just enough to combine. Salt to taste. It wants to taste properly seasoned.
7. Refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.

NOTES

Fold, do not beat. Overworking the potato after the dairy goes in turns it gummy.
 The potato is passed twice, through the ricer and then the tamis. That second pass is what makes it smooth enough to pipe.
 Whip the ricotta only to a frosting-like sheen. Past that point it breaks and weeps.
 The potato has to be completely cold before the crème fraîche meets it.
 It is a loose filling, so pasta made with it cooks at a simmer rather than a boil.

SHAPE

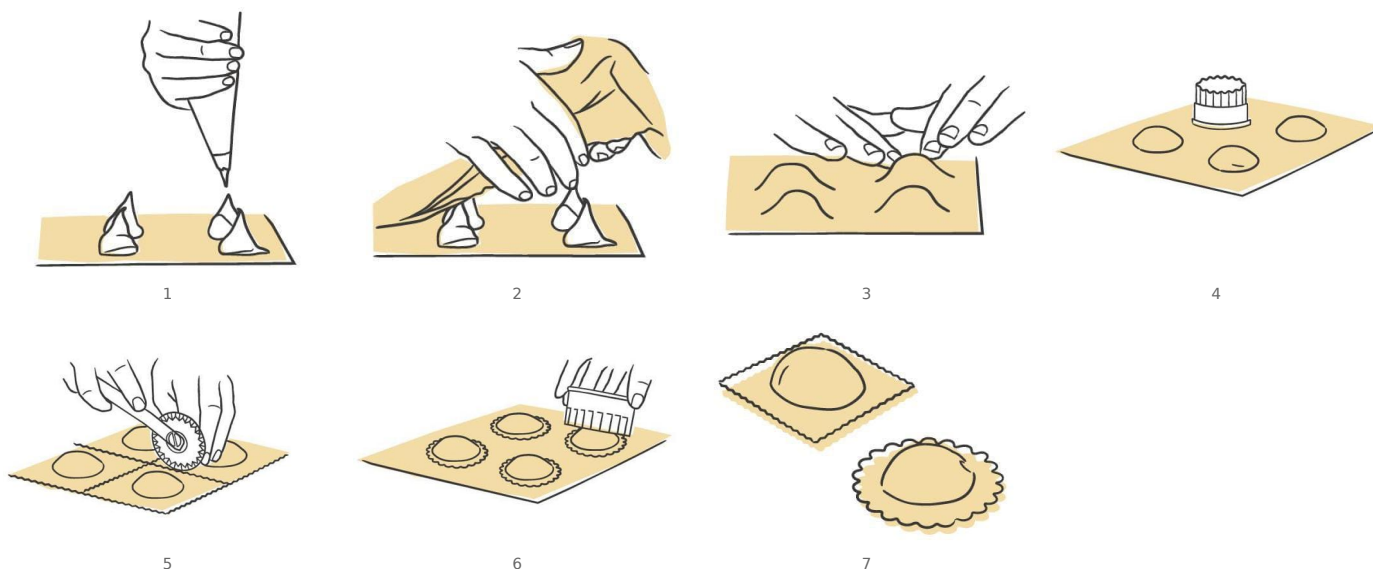
Ravioli

Region: All of Italy, north to south, and worldwide / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Trim the sheets to 18-inch lengths with a knife and cut away the ragged edges. Save the scraps for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Lay one sheet on the board. Using a pastry bag cut to a 1-inch opening, pipe mounds of filling roughly 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high in an even run down the sheet, leaving about 2 inches between mounds.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist it with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board so the second sheet will stick. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Lay a second sheet gently over the first, edges lined up and no wrinkles.
7. Press around each mound with your two index fingers to expel the air pockets. For insurance, flip a #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter to its dull side and press gently over each mound to expel the last of the air.
8. For square ravioli, cut 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted pastry cutter or fluted dough divider. A 2 1/2-inch fluted square cutter does the same thing.
9. For round ravioli, use a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter. Press straight down with your palm flat on top of the cutter, then twist it clockwise under that pressure to finish the cut.
10. Lift the sheets from one end to peel away the surrounding scrap. Discard it or save it for soup.
11. Set the pieces on the prepared pan in a single layer and dust the pan again with semolina.
12. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
13. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

SHAPING



NOTES

Two-sheet construction from 18-inch sheets. The filling goes on the bottom sheet and a second sheet covers it.
 Filling per piece: a mound 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high, piped through a 1-inch opening.
 Spacing: mounds 2 inches apart. The cut is either a 2 1/2-inch square or a 2 3/8-inch round.
 Cutters: #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter used dull side down to expel air, then either a fluted cutter or divider for 2 1/2-inch squares, or a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter for rounds.
 Cutting technique for rounds: press with a flat palm, then rotate clockwise under pressure so the cut goes all the way through. Air is expelled twice before cutting, first with two index fingers and then with the dull cutter.
 The author's restaurant version is round, roughly 2 inches across, with a ruffled edge. The square version is the red-sauce shape.
 Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
 Red sauce is the default finish. Otherwise the shape is a test bed for any filling.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
 Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
 Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
 Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

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